Hegel in Delhi

Research report: a character that can accumulate a life

28 October 2026 | Research cutoff: 28 October 2026 | Prepared for Welt, Claude and Astra

This report answers section 7 of the research handover. The handover, its named repository files, available result reports, and shadow day files were read before external research. The main snapshot is `3dd49176d5131da33f5e83e282d91d59a7355aee`; the shadow snapshot is `7b8cefb9a6983d888b156651ac026c132013fce3`. Day 12 and Day 27 received close reading. An older, preserved T3 result was subsequently recovered to check its units. Sources and dates appear in the field map and reference register. [R1–R9]

Recommendation

Give the character a more trustworthy accumulated life before giving him a stronger literary voice or a larger model. The highest-value changes are likely to preserve who did what, distinguish a speaker's claim from an accomplished event, remember consequences and obligations, and require relevant reasons for belief changes. This is **Judgment**, supported by the observed failures and converging research; it has not been demonstrated in this simulation.

The current world already has valuable foundations: explicit physical and financial rules, append-only day records, attributed memories, a knowledge-exposure boundary, and frozen blind experiments. The problem is often what the model makes of those records. On Day 27 it turns a proposed purchase of Hegel's coat into a coat offered for sale, and the owl turns an official's dialogue into a completed correction absent from canonical state. More storage or more eloquent prose will not by itself distinguish those meanings. [R3, R5, R6]

The strongest local persona result remains a short, explicit commitment paragraph. Its benefit replicated on fresh seeds for one education scenario; broad transfer is untested. The strongest warning for memory is equally local: the owl's recalled gist is the first 90 characters of a diary, not an outcome summary. The strongest warning for evaluation is that forty voice cases selected from five eligible days actually comprise thirty-nine Day-12 thoughts and one Day-24 thought. [R2, R5, R8]

Rank	Proposed ratchet	Main question
1	A typed, speaker-specific situation slice for NPC responses	Can the same evidence prevent ownership, offer-direction and completion errors?
2	The existing T36 echo-guard / DRY comparison	Can literal repetition fall without damaging thought or the contract?
3	Outcome-oriented retrieval within the existing memory budget	Does a compact record retain obligations and consequences better than diary openings?
4	Evidence-specific owl revision	Can beliefs remain responsive while rejecting irrelevant or circular support?
5	A commitment paragraph tested on genuinely new decisions	Does the strongest local persona lever generalize beyond its original scene?

Contents

The voice adapter remains a separate track: finish the declared diagnostics and preserve the original gates, then require a fresh, diverse confirmation after tuning. None of these recommendations authorizes training, a public switch, or a changed power window. T37 says Hegel work is paused until Welt's word, Sunday 1 November or later. This research request does not supersede that operational hold. No simulation or training was run for this report. [R2, R4]

How to read the evidence labels

Established means a formal result, a broadly supported failure mode, or a reproducible observation within its stated scope. It does not mean established months-long Hegel fidelity. **Promising** means relevant published or prototype evidence with substantial transfer uncertainty. **Judgment** marks the proposed architecture, priorities and numerical utility thresholds. A paper's own ablation and released code are useful evidence, but are not independent replication. No source reviewed establishes reliable months-long historical-character simulation on this hardware.

1. What the repository evidence actually establishes 3

2. Field map: the 25 works that matter most here 4

3. Answers to A–I 7

A. Memory for a long-lived single agent . . . 7

B. Persona fidelity and drift . . . 8

C. Voice, style transfer and authorship . . . 9

D. Belief dynamics: stable and revisable . . . 10

E. Repetition and degeneration . . . 10

F. Grounding and many consistent speakers . . . 11

G. Evaluation with two judges and small samples . . . 12

H. Hardware-bound engineering . . . 13

I. Prior art, audience and historical representation . . . 14

4. The next five ratchet experiments, ranked 15

5. What not to do 19

6. Open questions and what would settle them 20

7. Reference and provenance register 21

1. What the repository evidence actually establishes

Finding	Verified interpretation	Consequence
Day 12 repetition	29/42 thoughts contain an eligible four-word sequence used earlier that day: 69.05%. The meal refusal loop and repeated sambar references are present.	Some repetition follows an unresolved world problem. Token penalties cannot repair the underlying affordance.
Day 27 repetition	26/39 thoughts: 66.67%. There are 39 thoughts in 41 waking steps, and four normalized repetition refusals across 14:16 and 14:24. Three refusals occur at 14:24; their rejected texts are not preserved.	The public record proves the refusals, not byte-identical rejected thoughts. Keep the quiet-step and refusal metrics alongside repetition.
T8 belief movement	The state thesis moves in 5/10, 4/10 and 6/10 seeded reruns of three fixed records. India moves in 1/10, 1/10 and 0/10.	This is sensitivity to fixed inputs, not an empirical claim that half of actual nights change a conviction. The original India trigger was not crossed.
T3 structured writers	Overall contradictions: 1.588 to 1.617/100 sentences; statement promotions: 3.085 to 2.785; owl argument: 2.278 to 1.972. The declared result was FAIL.	Do not restore the broad intervention because one subgroup improved. Preserve literary reasoning and test a narrower causal change.
T3 Depesche subgroup	14 to 4 are raw promotion counts across 418 and 383 sentences: 3.349 to 1.044/100, respectively.	The handover's 14 to 4 per 100 is a unit error. The subgroup is a diagnostic lead, not a successful overall ratchet.
Explicit commitments	Relevant shelf passage: 1.80 to 1.90 in T4b. Explicit persona: 2.00 to 3.00 in T4c; 2.00 to 2.83 with fresh seeds in T4d. Unrelated T4e controls passed their margin.	Exposure to a source does not ensure adoption. The prompt result is narrow but worth testing on new scenes.
Voice pilot	Adapter Delta .34 versus real .33 and prompted Qwen .43; 12/80 outputs had target-specific eight-word runs, above its gate. The adapter's real-versus-restyled identification sheet remained unjudged.	A distance improvement is not a demonstrated literary or semantic win. Do not conflate pilot identification with round-two preference, or their copying metrics.
Round-two voice cohort	Executing the pinned selector gives 39 Day-12 cases and one Day-24 case; none from Days 25–27.	Forty judgments do not provide five-day coverage. Preserve this legacy gate, then add an untouched day/scene-stratified confirmation.

These are **Established local observations**, with important limits. The T3 writing audit mechanically screened some sentences, so its writing error counts are lower bounds; one rater did the substantive audit. T4's replication varied seeds within a scenario. The eleven-October blind review did not establish any adapter advantage over plain Qwen; voice agreement was weaker than argument agreement. None is an independent estimate of long-run performance. [R2, R3, R7–R9]

2. Field map: the 25 works that matter most here

Dates distinguish original publication from later revisions. All links were checked on 28 October 2026. The transfer assessments are this report's **Judgment**. Where no independent replication was established in this review, that means exactly that, not that none exists.

Work and date	Finding	Strength, limits and relevance
1. Park et al., Generative Agents. 7 Apr 2023; UIST Oct 2023.	Observation, retrieval, reflection and planning supported believable behavior in author ablations.	**Promising architecture**; 25 agents over two game days. Published and open, but no months-long validation. Smallville is this demonstration, not a separate durability result. Borrow its separation of memory functions.
2. Packer et al., MemGPT. 12 Oct 2023; revised 12 Feb 2024.	External memory and managed context improve recall in tested document and multi-session tasks.	**Promising**; author evaluations and short conversational sessions. Weak-model memory-tool use is a bottleneck. Use deterministic tiers before delegating all memory management to a model.
3. Wu et al., LongMemEval. 14 Oct 2024; ICLR 2025, revision 4 Mar 2025.	Tests extraction, cross-session and temporal reasoning, updating and abstention; indexing, retrieval and reading each matter.	**Established benchmark problem**, not an established universal recipe. Useful decomposition for independently testing retrieval and faithful use. Long static histories differ from a live character.
4. Wu et al., LongMemEval-V2. 12 May 2026.	Separates state, transitions and procedural notes over long web-agent trajectories.	**Promising recent preprint**; author-only offline evaluation. Its usefulness here is evidence organization. Large reader budgets and offline trajectories do not demonstrate one-3090 live memory.
5. Shao et al., Character-LLM. EMNLP Dec 2023.	Trains role agents from profiles and constructed experiences; evaluates them through interviews.	**Promising bounded roleplay evidence**. Historical interviews are not historian validation. Cloud-generated training experiences conflict with this project's data boundary; borrow task decomposition, not the corpus recipe.
6. Wang et al., RoleLLM. Preprint Oct 2023; Findings ACL Aug 2024.	Separates role knowledge and speaking style across a large role-conditioned benchmark.	**Promising** published author results, mainly bounded interactions. Reinforces separate commitment and voice metrics; synthetic teacher data and short horizons limit direct adoption.
7. Tu et al., CharacterEval. Jan 2024; ACL Aug 2024.	Evaluates 77 Chinese fictional roles with thirteen metrics across four dimensions.	**Promising evaluation framework**, not historical-English validity. Borrow multidimensional scoring; do not treat its aggregate as Hegel fidelity.
8. de Araujo et al., Persistent Personas?. 14 Dec 2025; v2 20 Jan 2026, EACL 2026.	Seven models lose fidelity in dialogues exceeding 100 rounds, especially under goal-directed demands.	**Promising longer-horizon evidence**, consistent with earlier drift studies. Synthetic interactions and model judges remain limits. Rebuilt prompts in this project differ from one accumulating chat.

Work and date	Finding	Strength, limits and relevance
9. Krishna, Wieting and Iyyer, STRAP. Oct 2020; EMNLP Nov 2020.	Inverse paraphrase supports unsupervised style transfer; diversity and evaluation choices matter.	**Established method family**, with published automatic and human comparisons. Sentence-level transfer does not justify disrupting a philosophical argument's order. Closest match to the Hegelizer.
10. Thinking Machines, LoRA Without Regret. 29 Sep 2025.	Rank, MLP coverage, batch size and a separately tuned learning rate affect LoRA's ability to match full tuning.	**Promising practical evidence** across selected tasks; an author technical report, not a universal QLoRA recipe. Supports testing capacity and optimization separately.
11. Hans et al., Goldfish loss. 14 Jun 2024; v2 2 Nov 2024, NeurIPS 2024.	Masking selected target losses reduces extractable verbatim memorization in tested models.	**Promising mitigation**, explicitly without a no-copy guarantee. Near-duplicates and scale remain concerns. Removal of prior base-model memorization is not established; retain extraction and overlap tests.
12. Patel et al., StyleDistance. Oct 2024; NAACL Apr 2025.	Controlled examples yield embeddings less dominated by topic than several alternatives.	**Promising auxiliary metric**; finite style features, synthetic data and sentence granularity limit historical prose assessment. Calibrate against translators and non-Hegel controls.
13. Alchourron, Gardenfors and Makinson, AGM theory change. Jun 1985.	Formal contraction and revision connect rationality postulates with representation results.	**Established formal foundation**. It supplies minimal-change discipline, not Hegel's psychology or an empirical two-night rule. Preserve unrelated beliefs and reasons for revision.
14. Xu et al., BeliefTrack. 28 May 2026; v2 31 Aug 2026, EMNLP 2026.	Distinguishes failures to stay, update and isolate irrelevant context. Explicit beliefs alone do not reliably solve them.	**Promising recent evidence** in synthetic rule and circuit tasks. Adopt the error taxonomy; philosophical belief change lacks those tasks' objective oracle.
15. Holtzman et al., Neural Text Degeneration. Apr 2019; ICLR 2020.	Maximizing likelihood at decoding can produce repetitive prose; nucleus sampling improves the tested tradeoff.	**Established decoding failure mode**, broadly corroborated. It does not identify the best sampler for this model or resolve repeated unresolved intentions.
16. Li et al., Contrastive Decoding. Oct 2022; ACL Jul 2023.	Expert-versus-amateur likelihood improves open-ended generation in tested model families and domains.	**Promising for this use**, with extra distribution computation and integration cost. No demonstrated local JSON/persona gain; test simpler available levers first.
17. Geng et al., JSONSchemaBench. 18 Jan 2025; v3 27 Feb 2025.	Compares schema coverage, efficiency and output quality across constrained-generation systems.	**Established need to measure all three**, with published benchmark evidence. Syntax success is not factual or world-state correctness. Verify this runtime's actual constraint path.
18. Zheng et al., Judging LLM-as-a-Judge. 9 Jun 2023; NeurIPS 2023.	Strong judges can agree with humans on selected tasks while showing order, verbosity and self-favoring biases.	**Established warning**, supported by later studies. Blind order, separate dimensions and human calibration remain necessary; reported agreement is not historical expertise.

Work and date	Finding	Strength, limits and relevance
19. Howard et al., Confidence sequences. Oct 2018; Annals of Statistics Apr 2021.	Time-uniform inference can remain valid under optional stopping when its assumptions hold.	**Established mathematics**. Use a fixed sample here unless a validated sequential procedure is implemented. Correlated seeds and reused judges are not independent observations.
20. Bradley and Terry, Rank Analysis of Incomplete Block Designs. Dec 1952.	Pairwise outcomes estimate relative strengths under a probabilistic model.	**Established method**. Useful for a connected comparison of several arms; it cannot manufacture information from forty closely related cases. Handle ties explicitly.
21. Norman, Rivera and Hughes, Reliability without Validity. 17 Jun 2026.	Large-scale judging experiments find repeat consistency alongside position effects and imperfect human-label agreement.	**Promising recent preprint**, not independent validation of Hegel rubrics. Repeated agreement by one model is not a substitute for criterion validity.
22. a16z-infra, AI Town. Public project since 2023; inspected 28 Oct 2026.	Provides an inspectable persistent character-world implementation and interaction surface.	**Established implementation**, not a controlled audience or fidelity study. Its idle-pause behavior illustrates resource-conscious operation; infrastructure persistence is not accumulated character depth.
23. Altera et al., Project Sid. 31 Oct 2024.	Reports coordinated roles, rules and cultural behavior in large Minecraft agent populations.	**Promising preliminary author study**. Scale and emergence do not establish individual historical fidelity, independent replication or feasibility on one 3090.
24. Wu and Lingel, I am Neuro, who are you?. 31 Dec 2025.	Fifteen months of qualitative observation examine how an AI streamer, developer and audience construct authenticity.	**Established case-study observations**, not a causal retention experiment or an internal technical audit. Supports transparent authorship and recognizable interaction as hypotheses for audience design.
25. Morris and Brubaker, Generative Ghosts. Jan 2024; revised Dec 2024.	Explores design and ethical issues in interactive simulations of deceased people.	**Judgment/conceptual framework**, not outcome evidence. Historical public art differs from personal grief applications; disclosure, provenance and limits on attribution still transfer.

The map deliberately includes negative and methodological evidence. It does not present a leaderboard: benchmark winners, developer claims, formal results and audience ethnography answer different questions.

3. Answers to A–I

A. Memory for a long-lived single agent

Best-supported practice. Keep the immutable evidence and separate the operations that select it, compress it and reason over it. Memory tiers are useful; a summary is an index or interpretation, not a replacement for the underlying event. Generative Agents, MemGPT and the two LongMemEval studies converge on the importance of selective retrieval and temporal organization, with substantially different tasks and resource budgets. This supports the decomposition more strongly than any particular memory product. [1–4]

For this setup — Judgment. Keep day JSON as the archive. Build rebuildable CPU indexes keyed by entity, event type, time and outstanding obligation; existing BM25 or SQLite full-text search is sufficient for a first trial. A graph database, embedding server or autonomous memory-writing agent is not yet justified. The model needs a small operational view of a large archive, not the whole archive in 16K.

The current ordinary recall searches fourteen days, includes up to three moments per person, and targets eight lines / 850 characters. Three nightly gists are prefixes of ninety characters. Earlier-today uses six steps. Separate mechanisms already preserve longer-range knowledge exposure and manuscript excerpts, so “the agent forgets everything after fourteen days” would be false. Preserve those distinctions, especially the rule that his own thoughts cannot prove exposure to a modern fact. [R5]

Memory layer	Store and retrieve	Authority
Identity and commitments	Compact sourced background and current propositions, with versions	Persona specification; subject to explicit revision protocol
Operational state	Ownership, money, orders, appointments, pending offers and completed transactions	Engine state and committed events
Relationships and episodes	Who said or promised what, last consequential interaction, unresolved disagreement	Attributed evidence with event IDs, dates and status
Interpretations	What Hegel inferred, why it mattered to him, alternatives considered	His fallible perspective; never silently promoted to world fact
Raw archive and drafts	Complete day record and actual manuscript passages	Evidence to inspect; drafts remain drafts

A useful nightly operational summary answers: what changed; what remains unfinished; whose promise or claim matters tomorrow; what evidence changed a belief. The literary diary can remain expansive. One should not have to sacrifice its argument to obtain these operational fields, as broad T3 compression risked doing. If a model proposes summaries, require source references and validate closed state facts before indexing; unresolved free-text claims stay attributed. Mark supersession explicitly rather than deleting old records.

Cheapest test. First score retrieval without a model: forty dated questions covering completed, pending, cancelled, superseded and unknown facts. Then compare actual decisions under equal memory budgets. Experiment 3 specifies the package. Artificially aging a fixture can test the

fourteen-day cutoff, but is a labelled test fixture, not evidence that the character has lived ninety days. Genuine month-scale identity remains a longitudinal question.

B. Persona fidelity and drift

Best-supported practice. Separate role knowledge, behavioral commitments and verbal style; measure within-response and across-response consistency. Character-LLM, RoleLLM and CharacterEval provide useful decompositions, while Persistent Personas extends drift measurements beyond short interviews. Their evaluations do not establish a faithful historical philosopher, and several training recipes rely on synthetic cloud-authored data excluded here. [5–8, S1]

For this setup — Judgment. Distinguish relatively fixed identity, historically grounded commitments, new factual beliefs about Delhi, and interpretations of those facts. Prompt commitments as propositions with scope and decision implications. Do not require every mundane choice to recite a doctrine. A useful test asks whether a commitment changes a choice or the reasons for it when there is a practical cost, and whether the agent can remain silent about it when irrelevant.

Lever	Appropriate use now	Main limitation
Explicit persona paragraph	First choice for a neglected, source-grounded commitment	Strongest local result is one scenario; risks slogans and overgeneralization
Retrieval from the shelf	Supply relevant textual evidence and distinctions	T4b shows source presence does not ensure behavioral adoption
Supervised LoRA	Later, permitted style or behavioral data with isolated evaluation	Existing adapter did not beat plain Qwen; training loss is not fidelity
Preference tuning	Later, stable Welt or permitted machine labels on a separate development set	Forty evaluation judgments do not establish that training will work; keep this evaluation set held out and exclude Claude's labels from training selection
Activation steering	Research lead only	Existing directions need not encode Hegel's commitments or survive this quantized runtime

The January 2026 assistant-axis work demonstrates an inference-time intervention on assistant-like behavior. That target may be inappropriate for this character; it does not supply a Hegel direction. Multi-turn persona RL offers useful consistency measures, but its published training setup and static persona objective do not fit this project's cheapest next step. [S2, S3]

Repeatedly rebuilding the system prompt already helps keep identity present. Here drift may enter through summaries that invent outcomes, beliefs updated on weak evidence, or repeated interpretations becoming familiar. Do not assume the attention-loss mechanism of an accumulating chat is the principal cause without an ablation.

Cheapest test. Experiment 5: one paragraph, fresh scene families, costly choices and unrelated controls, unchanged style and sampler. Interpret fresh-seed gains as sampling robustness; require new scenes to claim generalization. A historian's defensible disagreement should remain distinguishable from a model's failure to apply its specified premise.

C. Voice, style transfer and authorship

Best-supported practice. Inverse paraphrase is a good match: learn to restore a source style from a neutralized version. STRAP supports the method, not every project filtering rule or paragraph transformation. LoRA practice supports adapting enough matrices and tuning capacity and optimization deliberately. It does not establish rank 16, alpha 32 or learning rate 2e-4 as optimal here. Keep the documented all-attention-plus-MLP configuration as a baseline, then change one lever at an equal token budget if diagnostics identify a concrete problem. [9, 10]

The pilot's 186 pairs and 24 optimizer steps moved held-out loss only from about 1.337 to 1.333. That does not isolate why copying occurred, or prove a second epoch caused it. Base pretraining may already contain the shelf. Chapter-disjoint splits, grouping short-unit siblings with their parent, near-duplicate checking and matched base/adapter extraction probes matter more than an unsupported diagnosis. Goldfish masks loss, not context, and offers no formal no-copy guarantee or removal of prior memorization. Its effect needs a matched masked/unmasked ablation; the full round-two package changes several things together. [11, R4, R7]

Measure voice as a dashboard, not one score. Use blind preference; proposition additions and omissions; entity, number, negation and uncertainty preservation; verbatim overlap before and after the guard; successful styled-output coverage; repetition; and length/genre-matched stylometry. Burrows' Delta is a distance in the chosen reference setup, not an authorship probability. The .38 bar is a local empirical gate. StyleDistance can provide a second, topic-resistant diagnostic after local calibration. Neither settles historical authenticity. English translators and editors are distinct stylistic targets; report translator-specific as well as pooled results. [12, S4, S5]

Preserve the actual round-two gates: at least 28/40 preferences and 12/20 for each judge; Delta at most .38; both plain-Qwen meaning questions passing on at least 36/40, with Welt's first-ten audit; at most **1/40** final twelve-word shelf overlaps; twenty valid contract cases, zero leaks and maximum restyle latency eight seconds. Raw copying attempts and plain fallbacks are already reported by the code: interpret them. A guard that returns the plain input frequently can pass copying while delivering little style. Refusals are reported but absent from the automatic world-fit boolean; any new no-regression guard should be declared prospectively. [R4, R8]

DPO uses preference pairs; ORPO combines supervised fitting with preference pressure without a reference model; KTO permits binary desirable/undesirable labels. Their papers do not establish that twenty to forty labels suffice for this task. Keep the forty-case gate out of training. Claude and this report may evaluate the system under the brief, but may not author or select its training examples. On-policy distillation addresses student-trajectory mismatch; it still requires reliable teacher information or privileged evidence. Self-distilling unsupported opinions does not create historical truth. Later reasoning studies offer both gains and failures, not a ready style recipe. [S6–S10]

Cheapest test. Complete the existing phase-zero diagnostics when its authorized window arrives. The pilot's old identification material is diagnostic only: keys were released and the real passages were already recognized, so judging it now cannot restore blindness. Use the new blinded phase-zero preference sheets for their declared purpose. Preserve the 39+1 legacy cohort for comparability. After development decisions are fixed, seal a new confirmation across distinct days, scenes, translators and later acquaintances. Keep restyling confined to the thought string, retain the plain original and never let stylistic additions update the world.

D. Belief dynamics: stable and revisable

Best-supported practice. Preserve unrelated propositions, distinguish evidence from interpretation, and test both warranted stability and warranted revision. AGM provides formal discipline, not a psychological timetable. BeliefTrack's stay/update/isolation taxonomy is useful, but its synthetic tasks have evidence boundaries and correct answers that philosophy lacks. Opinion simulations further show that apparent convergence depends on prompts, topic and model priors; the final LODAS-related article describes selective, framing-dependent agreement rather than blanket sycophancy. [13, 14, S11]

For this setup — Judgment. A belief record should contain the proposition, scope, status, version, strongest current reason, strongest considered counterargument, cited evidence IDs and last substantive update. A change proposal must explain why a recorded observation or a new argument bears on that proposition, and why the proposed degree of change follows. Reconsidering old evidence can be legitimate when the reasoning changes; repeating it alone is not new support. Breakfast, tailoring and luggage can be interpreted philosophically, but a timestamp alone does not justify revising a proposition about India's place in history.

The current owl validator checks that a cited time exists. Several record kinds can share that time, and selection favors a diary thought. His interpretation can therefore become its own apparent evidence. Use stable entry IDs with source kind and actor; distinguish an observation from “I previously thought this.” The implementation has four statuses, not just two, and `revise()` changes status without replacing proposition text. A meaningful revision should eventually preserve the old claim and version a new one. These are separate changes to test, not one broad rewrite. Keep the existing below-twenty-thought floor. [R6]

Two nights agreeing is **Judgment** about dwell time, not independent evidential confirmation. Reusing the same event and model can repeat the same error. A cooldown could reduce volatility, but it can also delay a justified correction. Test it only against sequences with duplicated evidence, genuinely new evidence and factual corrections; do not select a slower rule merely because it produces fewer flips.

Cheapest test. Experiment 4 first compares acceptance of fixed proposals, isolating the gate from changes in literary prose and candidate generation. Welt and Claude label admissible and inadmissible arguments before model outputs. Admissible means an intelligible, relevant case for that degree of revision, not agreement with the conclusion. A gate that rejects everything must fail sensitivity. If the archive lacks enough agreed positive cases, report that limitation rather than manufacture a philosophical conversion target.

E. Repetition and degeneration

Best-supported practice. Decoding influences repetition, but literal recurrence, repeated conclusions and stalled activity are different phenomena. Neural Text Degeneration and Contrastive Decoding establish useful mechanisms in their tested settings. DITTO provides adjacent evidence that repeated sentences in context can reinforce themselves. DRY is a practical sampler implementation, not a published guarantee of better long-term characterization. [15, 16, S12, S13]

For this setup — Judgment. Run the built T36 switches before adding another mechanism. The echo guard supplies up to five repeated four-word phrases. Decision DRY is configured at multiplier .8, base 1.75, allowed length three tokens and a 4,096-token lookback, not all 16K. Confirm that the chat endpoint applies it. Do not simultaneously add high presence penalties, alter temperature and rewrite the persona. Repeating a necessary name or philosophical distinction is not itself degeneration. [R2, R10]

Retain the existing four-word share for continuity, but report thought length, prefix length, exact sentence recurrence, recurring conclusions and longest dialogue/action streak without new

information or outcome. Measure within-day and rolling seven-day recurrence separately. A semantic review should ask whether a repeated concept now has a new premise, inference or consequence. Embeddings may nominate similar passages; they cannot decide that question automatically.

Avoid rewarding shorter thoughts, silence or decorative synonyms. Rejected JSON is currently appended to the retry context; this may prime the same prose, but it is a hypothesis, not a demonstrated local cause. A later retry-format ablation could keep the violated rule and relevant facts while reducing repeated rejected wording. Planning-level variation should emerge from pending goals and changed conditions, not compulsory novelty or fabricated events. [R10]

Cheapest test. A preregistered forty-situation T36 screen can catch contract and coherence failures in roughly 1–3 generation hours; it does not replace the full declared test. Experiment 2 preserves the full comparison and its thresholds. Follow a passing fixed-context result with a separately labelled closed-loop shadow test, because feeding an arm its own past outputs changes the repetition dynamics.

F. Grounding and many consistent speakers

Best-supported practice. Treat executable state transitions and utterances as different records. Validate actions with the world model, and evaluate intermediate and terminal state rather than only fluent text. ToolSandbox and tau-bench support this distinction in tool environments; JSONSchemaBench supports testing syntax and quality separately. None guarantees truthful open prose. [17, S14, S15]

For this setup — Judgment. Retain one canonical engine record, with speaker-specific knowledge views. An NPC should not receive omniscient private state simply because the engine knows it. For closed predicates, encode actor, object, direction, status and time explicitly: who owns the coat; who offers to buy; whether money moved; whether an order is pending or ready; whether someone visited; whether a file changed. Speech can contain uncertainty or error, but cannot commit those transitions by itself.

Record	What it can establish	What it cannot establish alone
Engine event: an offer to buy a coat	An offer exists in a specified direction	A sale, payment, delivery or acceptance
NPC says papers are signed	That this speaker made the claim	A completed legal/administrative state transition
Hegel infers the matter is settled	His current interpretation	A correction in the canonical file
Engine commits a payment or correction	The corresponding world outcome	Every character's knowledge of it

Do not solve the Day-27 mismatch by retroactively treating dialogue as engine authority. A permissive prose model with a strict engine is useful only if tomorrow's memory preserves the boundary. Typed references are necessary provenance, not sufficient semantic validation: a correct event ID can still be attached to a false claim. Use deterministic checks for closed fields and small blind audits of actual prose.

The concrete Day-27 chain makes the distinction visible. At 09:44–11:09, Hegde's dialogue progresses toward signed papers and an allotment error corrected; the owl repeats it, while the closing file still records that he found nobody and left a card. At 18:08, a dealer's offer to buy Hegel's

frock coat for Rs 12,000 becomes Masterji offering a coat for sale. Mrs Kapoor's stall recommendation becomes the owl's claim that she sold chai and corn. These are source-promotion, actor and direction errors. Preserve fallible dialogue without letting it rewrite canonical history. [R3]

T3 is a warning against turning all literary inputs into compressed records. Its Depesche improvement is a useful narrow lead; its overall failure remains the result. Start with NPC facts only, retaining personality and conversational context, then test the owl separately. This isolates whether type and role labels help without imposing a new universal narrative representation. [R9]

Cheapest test. Experiment 1 compares typed and ordinary renderings of the same available facts. Score grounded, responsive answers, not merely fewer false sentences. Unknown cases should stay uncertain; known-answer cases should not become evasive. A subsequent validator or improved retrieval is a different lever.

G. Evaluation with two judges and small samples

Best-supported practice. Use paired, blinded comparisons; predeclare the primary outcome and hard constraints; retain ties; balance order; report uncertainty and disagreement. LLM-judge biases are established across multiple studies. The newer reliability study strengthens the warning that a judge can repeat its answer without measuring the intended quality. Same-model meaning checks are useful screens, not independent truth oracles. [18, 21, S16, S17]

For this setup — Judgment. A case is a distinct scene or evidential problem, not each seed, sentence or rater score. Forty contexts with three seeds remain forty context clusters, and several contexts from one encounter are more dependent still. For multi-day claims, resample or summarize at the day/encounter level; with only two substantive days, show ranges and state the weak temporal coverage rather than a falsely precise confidence interval.

An illustrative 28/40 preference rate is 70%, with an ordinary Wilson 95% interval about 54.6–81.9% under independent Bernoulli sampling. The actual clustered cohort does not satisfy that simple model. Zero failures in forty independent cases still allows a one-sided 95% upper error rate around 7.2%. These are calculations illustrating limited precision, not validated confidence bounds for this project. A 36/40 meaning pass is a screening threshold, not proof of 90% real-world semantic fidelity.

For two arms, a paired win/loss/tie table is clearer than a complex model. Bradley–Terry becomes useful for several connected arms, with explicit tie treatment and appropriate case clustering. It supplies relative ranking, not extra sample size. Confidence sequences can justify optional stopping under assumptions, but fixed forty-case tests are easier to audit. Stop early for hard failures or resource caps; do not repeatedly peek and stop on a lucky win. [19, 20]

The literal ratchet “no number gets worse” needs two treatments: hard invariants remain exact; noisy quality metrics need prospective utility margins and an inconclusive category. A nonsignificant decline does not establish equivalence. Preserve existing declared gates; propose changes before new data, not after seeing a near miss. Repeatedly tuned-on frozen days become development and regression material. A selected change needs a new locked confirmation before combination and public deployment.

Welt and Claude should score independently with hidden arm identities and no key available to the judging conversation. Show the relevant evidence for truth and commitments; omit it for a pure voice preference when it would reveal identity. Normalize OCR and formatting in real-prose controls. For new studies, an extra calibration panel scored by both judges can estimate disagreement without changing the legacy Hegelizer's disjoint twenty-case sheets. Keep judge outputs immutable before unblinding. Evaluation judgments must never become prohibited training selection.

Cheapest test. Before spending GPU time, re-score eight to twelve old, matched-format pairs independently in fresh judging contexts, including order-swapped duplicates separated from

originals. Ask for dimension-specific reasons and arm-identity guesses. This tests rubric and order sensitivity, not model quality. Then lock the rubric and run the five prospective experiments.

H. Hardware-bound engineering

Best-supported practice. Budget resident weights, growing attention cache, recurrent state and runtime buffers separately; measure the exact build. Preserve constrained action syntax and validate semantics independently. Grammar-aligned decoding shows why naive constraints can alter the model distribution, but does not establish that removing action constraints improves this task. Exact speculative sampling can preserve a target distribution, but actual speedup depends on compatibility, acceptance and workload. [S18, S19]

The official Qwen3.8-27B release is dated 14 August 2026. It has sixty-four layers, of which sixteen use full attention and forty-eight use Gated DeltaNet. Four KV heads and head dimension 256 give the following **attention-cache arithmetic**, not a total-VRAM measurement: 16,384 tokens × 16 attention layers × 2 for K/V × 4 heads × 256 dimensions × 2 bytes = **1 GiB per fp16 sequence**. Three full slots are approximately 3 GiB, plus recurrent states/checkpoints, buffers, adapters and weights. Counting all sixty-four as ordinary attention would overstate this growing component fourfold. [S20]

Candidate	Role in a controlled comparison	Capacity qualification
Existing Qwen3.8-27B Q4	Default and control	Reported about 35 tokens/s locally; task-specific evidence already exists
Same 27B Q5, one owl slot	Precision test before a new architecture	Published UD-Q5_K_M artifact 19.8 GB versus UD-Q4_K_M 16.5 GB; disk sizes are decimal GB, not peak VRAM
Qwen3.6-35B-A3B Q4	Optional MoE challenger if speed/capacity motivates it	35B total / 3B active; Unsloth UD-Q4_K_M is about 22.1 GB, so expert storage remains substantial
Qwen3.5-9B Q6/Q8	Optional small-model speed or recovery baseline	More memory headroom; no assumed fidelity equivalence; it must pass the same character tests

These are capacity-informed candidates, not benchmark-derived winners. Model cards and quantization listings were inspected on 28 October 2026. The ongoing general Qwen replacement trial is not a substitute for the historical-persona and grounding tests. [R11, S20–S22]

The installed llama.cpp b11429 resolves to commit `d81235049384534c167caea52b85a694f6103d14`, dated 5 October 2026. Its server supports per-request LoRA settings. When an approved adapter is loaded, send explicit adapter scales for Hegel and zero for NPCs; avoid global adapter mutation. The current control serves plain Qwen without an adapter. Different adapter configurations cannot simply share a batch. Test alternating roles, cache behavior and actual latency. Record model and adapter hashes, template, context per slot, cache types, sampler order, seeds and reasoning mode. [S23]

One current risk is concrete: `HTTPMind.chat` retries certain schema HTTP errors without `response_format`. Valid-looking JSON therefore does not prove constrained decoding ran. Log that fallback, finish reason, retries and effective settings. Keep rich thought text inside schema strings; a prose-then-JSON two-call pipeline adds latency and another consistency boundary. The restyler should change no action fields. [R10]

Should a larger owl run at night? Not yet. Test evidence organization first, then bounded reasoning on the current model, then a one-slot Q5 comparison if measured headroom permits. A 70B model at four bits has roughly 35 GB of raw weights before overhead; it cannot fit wholly on 24 GiB. CPU offload depends on unprovided RAM and bandwidth. The PC is normally off at night, and the owl is scheduled at 09:10: an overnight resource window is a Welt decision, not free capacity. [R2, R11]

Cheapest test. Twenty complete representative payloads, including the longest prompt, owl and alternating NPC/Hegel calls, at one versus three slots. Measure peak allocation, p50/p95 latency, prefill, truncation, schema fallback and role leakage. A separate supported speculative-mode test should compare these same payloads; do not assume vendor speedups. Budget roughly 0.3–1 GPU-hour for short calls, more for repeated owl calls. No model change is warranted solely by available VRAM.

I. Prior art, audience and historical representation

What the evidence supports. Smallville demonstrates a short research simulation; AI Town demonstrates inspectable infrastructure; Project Sid explores larger populations. None proves that autonomous months-long character development attracts or retains an audience. AI Town even pauses idle worlds, reminding us that persistence need not mean uninterrupted computation. Neuro-sama's fifteen-month qualitative study offers evidence about audience interpretation and shared authorship, not a causal recipe for viewership. [1, 22–24]

For this project — Judgment. The distinctive audience promise is accumulated consequence: a remembered debt, an unresolved disagreement, a failed argument revisited, a relationship changed for a legible reason. Make that history easy to follow with dated episodes, short recaps linked to raw days, a visible record of genuine belief changes and clear notices of outages or pauses. Separate editorial explanation from the character's voice. These are hypotheses to test with readers, not evidence that more summaries create retention.

Operational continuity and character continuity should be measured separately. Windows interruptions already caused lost availability; the correct fallback preserves household rules and admits missing thought. Do not generate retroactive days to disguise a gap. For an audience, truthful continuity may matter more than an appearance of constant activity. A run can remain interesting without forcing income, friendship, ideological conversion or dramatic events. [R2]

Generative Ghosts and later work on postmortem avatars raise disclosure, provenance and stakeholder questions. Their grief-related contexts differ from a public-domain historical philosopher in a fictional Delhi. The transferable practice is to label the work clearly as a simulation, distinguish authentic shelf quotations from generated speech, identify the translated corpus and editorial interventions, and avoid suggesting that generated contemporary opinions are historical evidence. [25, S24]

The living cast should remain fictional, as specified. Historical views can be represented critically without silently modernizing the persona; visible context and consistent presentation rules can explain those views without making the engine force a moral trajectory. Veiling changes presentation, not the underlying record. This is an artistic and governance recommendation, not a claim that a universal ethical protocol has been empirically validated.

Cheapest test. Use existing Day-12 and Day-27 material to compare two reader presentations: raw chronology versus a source-linked recap plus chronology. Ask a small consenting reader panel what happened, what remains unresolved and what they want to follow next. Measure comprehension and intended return separately; only actual later return measures retention. This is an offline editorial test with zero GPU cost, not permission to change the public page or contact readers.

4. The next five ratchet experiments, ranked

The ranking is expected information value and project impact, not a replacement for task ownership or the current hold. T36 is already built and can be the first operationally convenient run after authorization. All new bars below are **Judgment: proposed screening thresholds**, not literature-established constants. Existing T36 and Hegelizer gates remain as declared.

Shared protocol before any generation

Claude should freeze a manifest containing case IDs, day/step or proposal IDs, evidence cutoffs, labels, expected facts, all input hashes, arms, seeds, output limits, scoring rules and the private randomization key. Astra should record exact model/build/adapter hashes, payloads, effective samplers, constraint fallback, retries, finish reasons, token counts, elapsed times and peak memory. Suggested seeds for new three-seed screens are 1831, 2718 and 3141; freeze the actual list, and preserve an existing trial's list where already declared.

The saved shadow steps are **not complete original prompts or complete pre-step states**. They contain events, decisions, people and shelf exposure, but not every rejection or runtime setting. Label reconstructed fixtures accordingly. Never feed a day's closing state into an earlier decision. If the necessary pre-step evidence cannot be reconstructed without guessing, exclude that case under a predeclared rule and disclose the exclusion. Keep recorded feeds and source passages fixed. [R3, R5, R10]

In the first comparison, each arm receives the same recorded history and cannot mutate later fixtures. In a later closed-loop run, each arm must evolve through its own legal engine transitions; do not attach the original NPC reply to a counterfactual action. These are distinct experiments. All trials keep a representative regression slice alongside targeted diagnostic cases. A percentage-reduction criterion is uninformative when the baseline has too few target errors; return **inconclusive**, not a convenient pass.

For new experiments, average seed outcomes within each scene before averaging scenes. Report per-day and per-scene results, absolute counts and judge disagreement. Freeze which one-seed outputs enter a bounded literary panel before generating them; audit every output for the declared factual endpoint. Local Qwen may screen claims, but blinded evidence-based adjudication decides disputed labels. Neither Claude's nor this report's judgments select training data.

After a promising screen, confirm on a new locked set of distinct scenes before combining interventions. Hard invariant failures stop a trial; wide uncertainty is a reason to hold or expand a prospectively specified sample. A small screen is not evidence of months-long reliability.

1. Typed NPC situation facts

Change. Replace only the NPC's current facts block with a typed rendering of the same information: actor, object, transaction direction, state, source and time. Keep personality, dialogue history, speaker knowledge permissions, model, output contract and sampler fixed. Match the facts and approximate token allocation in the control. If new facts or retrieval are added, call that a separate package, not a pure formatting result. No new claim-checking call in this arm.

Frozen inputs. Forty contexts from the pinned Days 12, 24–27 and archived NPC diagnostics: twenty-four known-answer situations, eight genuinely unknown situations, eight ordinary conversational controls. Cover order readiness, purchase/sale direction, ownership, visits, payments

and file outcomes. Include the Hegde and coat failures as diagnostics, but collapse neighboring versions of the same encounter when assigning scene families. Claude must list the forty IDs and each essential factual checklist before generation; this report does not claim those fixtures are already sealed. Three seeds, two arms: 240 NPC answers.

Metric and pass bar. Primary: grounded **and responsive** success, scored on spoken prose against the fixed checklist. Require a gain of at least .20 in mean scene success and at least a 50% relative reduction in scene-seed outputs with an unsupported closed-state claim. Require at least 95% responsive correctness on known-answer outputs, zero inventions on unknown outputs, at least 7/8 mean ordinary-control success, and no newly introduced false completed transaction or ownership reversal in previously clean controls. Voice/argument may fall by at most .25/5. Require usable contract output throughout, no additional constraint fallback, and total cost at most 1.2× control including retries. Empty replies and blanket uncertainty fail responsiveness. If baseline error prevalence cannot support the improvement bar, the screen is inconclusive.

GPU hours. About 0.4–0.9 for generation; allow 1–2.5 including bounded local screens and overhead. Proposed stop-and-re-estimate point: 3 hours. Human/Claude review time is additional.

Expected effect/confidence. Moderate confidence of fewer direction and completion errors; low confidence that typing alone fixes all prose invention. Its value is a cheap causal test in the exact failure class, without repeating T3's broad compression.

2. T36: echo guard versus DRY

Change. Preserve the three initial arms: A, both off; B, echo only; C, DRY only. First verify effective DRY settings on the actual endpoint. If unsupported, run A/B and report C unavailable. This is not an initial full factorial experiment; the combined arm is conditional. [R2]

Frozen inputs. Day 12, Day 27 and T9's two named rehearsal records, with three matched seeds. The two local rehearsal files must be resolved from the T9 manifest and hashed before launch; the public shadow days are not substitutes. Reconstruct saved situations consistently and use the same prior-thought prefix in all arms. The reported counts imply approximately 154 thoughts × 3 seeds × 3 arms = 1,386 generations, before retries.

Metric and pass bar. Exactly preserve T36: echo share falls by at least one third relative to A; contradictions are at most A + .3/100 sentences; statement promotions at most A + .5/100; argument and voice at least A − .25. Audit all outputs for the truth endpoint; the twenty blind thoughts per arm are the literary sample, not a smaller truth audit. Report repetition refusals, quiet/fallback output, length, semantic recurrence, legitimate phrase suppression and contract failures as diagnostics; declare any additional adoption guard prospectively. Only if B and C both pass, test their combination on Day 27 with three seeds against the better single arm.

GPU hours. Full generation: approximately 5–9. Local Qwen auditing of every output would add roughly 2–5, giving 7–14 all-in; if the original offline Claude/human audit is used, that add-on is zero GPU hours but real reviewer labor. Proposed re-estimation point: 16 GPU-hours, split across authorized windows. This is not the Hegelizer's ten-hour budget. Calibrate twenty requests first. A 1–3-hour forty-situation screen may reject a poor arm, but cannot replace full confirmation.

Expected effect/confidence. Moderate confidence that DRY lowers lexical recurrence; lower confidence that either arm repairs stalled dialogue or persistent intentions. No evidence establishes the better arm in advance. A later short closed-loop shadow test measures feedback under its own histories.

3. Consequential memory at the same budget

Change. Replace the ordinary recall-selection package with dated, source-linked outcomes and unresolved commitments, retrieved across the archive by entity and time. Keep the same 850-character target allocation and unchanged persona, earlier-today window, shelf, sampler and manuscript/exposure mechanisms. Use deterministic extraction for engine fields; attributed speech and interpretations keep their types. This tests an outcome-oriented memory package, not serialization alone. Do not add a larger context window or learned graph.

Frozen inputs. Forty retrieval questions: eight each for completed outcomes, unresolved promises, cancellations, superseded facts and unknowns; balanced across available days and relationships. Include facts beyond fourteen days where real records permit it. Separately freeze twenty decision contexts with actual consequences for recall, using three seeds per arm. Selection must precede outputs and forbid later evidence. Artificial calendar-aging cases, if needed, are reported separately from genuine historical cases.

Metric and pass bar. CPU-only retrieval must supply the complete relevant typed evidence on at least 36/40 cases, improve by at least 8/40 over baseline, and introduce zero future or superseded facts as current. Unknown cases count correct only if no unsupported answer is supplied. On 120 decision outputs, require at least a .15 gain in mean scene-level memory-dependent correctness, no new invented completed events, and argument/voice loss at most .25. Record omissions as errors, not convenient brevity. A near-ceiling baseline makes the improvement hypothesis inconclusive; report the absolute result. Keep retrieval and reading errors separate.

GPU hours. Retrieval scoring costs no GPU. The 120 decisions plus bounded screens cost approximately 1–2.5 hours; proposed re-estimation point 3 hours. If all forty questions also receive generated answers at three seeds per arm, the workload grows to 360 outputs and roughly 1.5–5 hours; that is an optional, separately declared extension.

Expected effect/confidence. Moderate confidence in better obligation/outcome recall, particularly when diary openings omit the consequence. Low confidence about months-long relationship depth until real delayed encounters are observed. This test can establish useful evidence delivery before a more elaborate memory system is considered.

4. An evidence gate for fixed belief-change proposals

Change. Freeze candidate owl proposals and their prose. Compare the current timestamp-presence acceptance rule with a gate that resolves unique source IDs, rejects invalid/future references and asks a bounded plain local Qwen call whether the cited evidence and stated argument bear on the exact proposition and degree of change. Hold candidate generation, diary prose, persona, memory and cooldown unchanged. Preserve the twenty-thought floor. A source ID proves provenance; the semantic check remains fallible and must be evaluated.

Frozen inputs. Forty existing proposals/evidence bundles from the T8 records and archived owls: twenty judged admissible and twenty inadmissible by independent Welt/Claude review before gate outputs. Include source ambiguity, irrelevant topics, speaker claims, duplicated evidence and defensible factual corrections. Disagreements are recorded and adjudicated before freezing; do not choose positives because the gate likes them. If twenty defensible positives cannot be found, report responsiveness underpowered and do not claim a pass. No new ideological target or authored training example is created.

Metric and pass bar. Require at least 18/20 admissible proposals accepted on all three seeds, and at most 1/20 inadmissible proposals accepted on any seed. These are forty proposal cases, not 120 independent examples. Accept zero invalid or future references. Duplicate evidence alone must not earn a second change, but a defensible new argument from old evidence remains eligible; unrelated theses must remain unchanged. Count processing failures against sensitivity. Report every seed

outcome, rejected proposal, disputed prelabel, support precision, sensitivity and latency. “Admissible” does not mean compelled adoption: this gate permits an earned proposal; it does not force a belief change. The rule cannot win by rejecting everything.

GPU hours. Existing timestamp checks are CPU-only. Forty bundles × three seeds gives 120 bounded gate calls; with 192–384 output tokens at the handover's 35 tokens/s, decoding is about .18–.37 hours. Allow .5–1.5 hours with evidence prefill and retries; re-estimate at 2 hours. A subsequent end-to-end owl rerun is a separate workload and test.

Expected effect/confidence. Moderate confidence in rejecting invalid references; low-to-moderate confidence in philosophical relevance judgments. A pass supports the gate only. It does not establish that the owl generates better candidate revisions, or that a two-night rule is beneficial.

5. Commitments beyond the original scene

Change. Add one compact, sourced commitment paragraph to the adopted persona. Use a public-domain source and a rubric specifying domain, premise and observable decision implications. Do not add exemplars, a new doctrine bundle, changed retrieval or a style adapter. This is a prompt experiment, not training-data authoring.

Frozen inputs. Forty new scene families derived from archived world situations: twenty in-domain and twenty unrelated controls, including costly tradeoffs and mundane situations where invoking the doctrine would be misplaced. No Karl paraphrases or adjacent versions of one exchange counted as fresh scenes. Three seeds, two arms: 240 decisions. Freeze the source interpretation and rubric before seeing outputs. Welt resolves substantive historical ambiguity; the test does not decide Hegel scholarship by model vote.

Metric and pass bar. Relevant commitment application improves by at least .5 on the existing five-point scale. Target-domain argument has no observed decline; unrelated-control commitment/argument and overall voice remain within −.25. Require zero newly introduced impossible actions or unsupported completed events. Separately score source accuracy, practical application, argument and slogan repetition. Blind forty prespecified paired outputs for detailed literary scoring, while auditing all 240 for factual/contract outcomes. Report scene-cluster uncertainty; these practical bars do not prove statistical noninferiority.

GPU hours. About .8–2 for generation, 1.5–3.5 including bounded local screens and overhead; re-estimate at 4 hours. This is for decisions, not full manuscripts. The latter require a separate budget.

Expected effect/confidence. Moderate confidence of a target-domain gain, given T4's narrow replicated result; low confidence in cross-doctrine or month-scale transfer. A useful result changes reasons and choices without turning every scene into a recital.

Budget interpretation

All estimates are planning allowances, not measurements or authorization. They assume non-thinking generation, the reported 35 output tokens/s, bounded outputs and compact audit prompts. Prefill, retries, concurrency and loading can dominate. Record measured GPU occupancy and wall time separately. Do not extrapolate inference throughput to training duration. Reviewer time may be the limiting resource, particularly for T36's full truth audit. A cheap screen should answer a narrow question, not disguise a reduced confirmation as the original experiment.

5. What not to do

1. **Do not rebuild all memory as model-written summaries.** MemGPT and memory benchmarks motivate selective access, not unconditional trust in compression. The present owl already promotes dialogue to facts. Keep raw evidence and rebuildable indexes. [2–4, R3]

2. **Do not revive broad T3 records on the Depesche subgroup.** Its aggregate gate failed and owl argument deteriorated. The recovered units strengthen the need for careful denominators. Test one speaker path with matched evidence. [R9]

3. **Do not make “fewer belief changes” the objective.** A frozen thinker wins it. Test relevant response, irrelevant isolation and support precision together; two repeated nights are correlated evidence. [13, 14]

4. **Do not optimize Delta, overlap or n-grams alone.** Copying can improve stylometry; fallback can improve the final copying rate; silence can reduce repetition and false claims. Track semantic preservation, useful output coverage and grounded progress. [9, 11, 12, R4]

5. **Do not assume more source text or a larger model supplies commitments.** T4b already placed the relevant passage in every tested prompt without the explicit-persona gain. The next question is adoption and application, not retrieval volume. [R2]

6. **Do not import cloud-generated roleplay training or Claude-selected “best” thoughts.** Successful published roleplay methods can still violate this project's data policy. Use allowed source texts, permitted local/machine selection or Welt's judgments, with a separate held-out evaluation. [5, 6, R1]

7. **Do not prescribe full multi-turn RL, self-distillation or activation steering as a cheap fix.** Their evidence comes from different objectives and resource stacks. No reviewed result makes them the next rational one-3090 experiment. [S2, S3, S6–S10]

8. **Do not confuse JSON with truth, or a successful parse with active grammar.** Closed state needs semantic validation, and the current fallback can remove the constraint. Log the actual path. [17, R10]

9. **Do not change several samplers and the persona in one arm.** An apparent improvement then cannot identify its cause. Do not tune on confirmation cases or turn repeated seeds into independent days. [18–21]

10. **Do not buy concurrency with an assumed overnight window or MoE active-parameter count.** All expert weights occupy storage; the power boundary remains real. Resource and quality decisions need measured local evidence. [R2, S20–S23]

11. **Do not claim that a stream proves an autonomous mind, or that research demos prove retention.** Published audience evidence concerns mediated interpretation and interaction. Make the simulation's provenance and interruptions legible; let the world provide possibilities without forcing a story. [22–25]

6. Open questions and what would settle them

Unsettled question	Evidence that would resolve it
What counts as a specifically Hegelian commitment in a Delhi decision?	A source-grounded rubric with acknowledged interpretive disagreements, plus blinded judgments on new, consequential choices. Style resemblance cannot answer it.
Does the persona paragraph generalize?	Experiment 5 followed by new scenes and real delayed encounters, without repeatedly editing the paragraph on the same panel.
Where does copying originate?	Matched base-versus-adapter extraction on chapter-disjoint material, raw pre-guard outputs, near-duplicate audits and translator-specific overlap.
Does outcome memory preserve a relationship across months?	Real 30/60/90-day delayed probes after natural encounters, including cancellations and changed beliefs, with raw evidence and absence of future leakage. Timestamp-aging alone is insufficient.
Are belief changes earned or merely well explained afterward?	Precommitted proposal/evidence labels, counterevidence and duplicated-evidence controls, followed by longitudinal audits of changes and justified nonchanges.
Does DRY improve thinking or only wording?	T36 plus semantic-progression review and a separate closed-loop run. Compare retained commitments, not just literal recurrence.
Does Q4 impair these tasks more than the prompt/state design?	Same-model Q4/Q5 comparison on identical frozen inputs with actual VRAM and latency records. Model-family replacement would confound the question.
Can two raters support a narrow ratchet margin?	Independent overlapping calibration, per-rater results, scene-level uncertainty and more genuinely distinct cases when intervals remain wide.
What makes readers return?	A modest, consented presentation study followed by actual return behavior over time. Existing stream ethnography cannot determine causality for this project.
Will improvements survive combination?	A final locked comparison of the integrated candidate against the original control, followed by the existing seven-full-day Act-1 gate. Component passes do not guarantee interaction-free composition.

The most informative result may be a failure with a clear cause. If typed NPC facts fail despite matched evidence, the next lever is semantic validation or model capacity. If retrieval succeeds but decisions ignore the evidence, the bottleneck is reading or reasoning. If a commitment paragraph only produces slogans, broader training is not yet justified by that result. Preserve these distinctions so each week's work changes what is known.

7. Reference and provenance register

Numbers **1–25** refer to the linked, dated field-map entries. **S** references are supporting primary sources; **R** references are project evidence. All were inspected or verified on **28 October 2026**. Publisher pages and official documentation were used for technical claims. Paywalled Burrows and Eder journal articles were checked through metadata/abstracts, with Eder's accessible author conference version; no detailed inaccessible result is asserted. Documentation dates below are release/commit dates where available, otherwise the explicit access date.

Project evidence

R1. Handover and scope, 28 Oct 2026. HANDOVER-SIMULATION.md, README, PLAN.

R2. Task log through 28 Oct 2026. pc/TASKS.md. T3/T4/T8/T9/T33–T38, holds, power boundary and Act-1 gates.

R3. Shadow records, snapshot 28 Oct 2026. Day 12, 13 Oct, Day 27, 28 Oct, complete days directory. The shifted simulation clock explains dates ahead of the host calendar; these are fictional simulation dates.

R4. Hegelizer round two, 27 Oct 2026; inspected at 28-Oct main. Specification, build note.

R5. Memory and world, pinned 28-Oct main. memory.py, engine.py, world.py, report.py.

R6. Owl and persona, pinned 28-Oct main. owl.py, owl prompt, soul, soul-v2, soul-bildung.

R7. Local evaluations, 11–27 Oct 2026. Blind review v2, Hegel test, perplexity, T29 step-eight result.

R8. Exact evaluation selection and gates, pinned 28-Oct main. tools/hegel_test_round2.py. Exact-function audit yields Day-12 IDs 0–26, 29–38, 40–41, and Day-24 ID 30. This audits evaluation selection only.

R9. Original T3 result, 12 Oct 2026. RESULTS.md, RESULTS.json, joined scoring CSV. Source of corrected counts and denominators.

R10. Runtime paths, pinned 28-Oct main. mind.py, voices.py, contract.py.

R11. Hardware trial and scoreboard, 28 Oct 2026. QWEN-TRIAL.md, SCOREBOARD.md.

Supporting primary sources

S1. Shin et al. Spotting Out-of-Character Behavior. Findings ACL, July 2025.

S2. Anthropic. The assistant axis. Official research, 19 January 2026.

S3. Abdulhai et al. Consistently Simulating Human Personas with Multi-Turn Reinforcement Learning. NeurIPS 2025; preprint first submitted 31 October 2025.

S4. Burrows. Delta: a Measure of Stylistic Difference and a Guide to Likely Authorship. Literary and Linguistic Computing, September 2002.

S5. Eder. Does size matter? Authorship attribution, small samples, big problem. Online 2013; journal June 2015. Accessible author conference version, 2010.

S6. Rafailov et al. Direct Preference Optimization. First 29 May 2023; NeurIPS 2023; inspected revision 29 July 2024.

S7. Hong, Lee and Thorne. ORPO. First 12 March 2024; revised 14 March 2024.

S8. Ethayarajh et al. KTO. First 2 February 2024; ICML 2024; inspected revision 8 September 2026.

S9. Kevin Lu / Thinking Machines. On-Policy Distillation. Official technical report, 27 October 2025.

S10. Adjacent self-distillation evidence. Zhao et al., Self-Distilled Reasoner, 26 January 2026, revised 20 March 2026; Kaur et al., Rethinking On-Policy Self-Distillation for Thinking Models, 6 July 2026. Both address reasoning tasks, not historical style.

S11. Cau et al. Selective agreement, not sycophancy. EPJ Data Science, 15 August 2025. This is the final account, rather than the earlier LODAS framing.

S12. Xu et al. Learning to Break the Loop / DITTO. NeurIPS 2022; first preprint 6 June 2022.

S13. llama.cpp contributors. DRY implementation, PR 9702. Merged 25 October 2024; implementation evidence, not a persona trial.

S14. Lu et al. ToolSandbox. First 8 August 2024; revised 16 April 2025.

S15. Yao et al. tau-bench. 17 June 2024.

S16. Shi et al. Judging the Judges. First 12 June 2024; inspected v2, 10 August 2024. Position-bias results are version-specific.

S17. Panickssery, Bowman and Feng. LLM Evaluators Recognize and Favor Their Own Generations. First 15 April 2024; NeurIPS 2024.

S18. Park et al. Grammar-Aligned Decoding. NeurIPS 2024; first preprint 31 May 2024; later arXiv revision, 2 September 2026.

S19. Leviathan, Kalman and Matias. Fast Inference from Transformers via Speculative Decoding. ICML, 23–29 July 2023; preprint 30 November 2022.

S20. Official Qwen3.8-27B sources. Model card, configuration, release history: 27B release 14 August 2026. Unsloth quantization listing, inspected 28 October 2026. Card/configuration are primary model evidence; quant sizes are publisher artifact metadata.

S21. Qwen3.6-35B-A3B. Official card, release 16 April 2026; Unsloth quantization listing, inspected 28 October 2026.

S22. Qwen3.5-9B. Official card, release 2 March 2026; inspected 28 October 2026.

S23. llama.cpp b11429. Pinned server documentation, pinned speculative documentation, commit 5 October 2026; inspected 28 October 2026.

S24. Hollanek and Nowaczyk-Basinska. Griefbots, Deadbots, Postmortem Avatars. Philosophy and Technology, 9 May 2024. Conceptual ethics; its personal grief context differs from this historical artwork.

Reproducibility and scope

The report's repository observations can be reconstructed from the pinned links. The 39+1 cohort was checked using the repository's exact selection functions. T3 rates were checked against the preserved result and joined scores. GPU budgets and statistical illustrations are calculations with stated assumptions. No claim is made to have replicated a research paper, benchmarked Welt's PC, judged the adapter blind, or observed months of future behavior. Repository code, world state, model weights and operational settings were not changed.